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Week 8 Lit Example Worksheet

MACBETH: FAIR, FOUL, AND SHIFTING SECURITY

Purpose: Apply Week 8's method to *Macbeth*. Expose shifting terms and retest the inference with fixed meanings.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not retell the whole plot.

Part 1: Fair and the Greetings

Question 1.1

In Passage 1, give two ordinary senses of *fair* that the language can carry.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

From Macbeth's point of view in Passage 1, which greeting is already established, which is not yet established, and which explicitly concerns the future? Why does that difference matter for a stable argument?

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: From Sounding Fair to Acting

Question 2.1

Reconstruct the risky inference Macbeth may draw from the witches' words in a middle-term shape (even if informal). Name the term that is doing the linking work.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

Explain why that link is an ambiguous middle or term shift rather than a stable proof that he must be king by crime.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: Security Promises

Question 3.1

For “none of woman born shall harm Macbeth,” state Sense A (how Macbeth hears it) and Sense B (a different sense that later undercuts the guarantee).

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

For the Birnam wood promise, state Sense A and Sense B, then say whether Macbeth’s “That will never be” still follows under both fixed senses.

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Repair

Question 4.1

Rewrite one of the security arguments with fixed meanings so that it no longer falsely guarantees Macbeth's safety.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

In one paragraph, explain how Week 8's tool changes a reading of these passages from "magic prophecy" to "unstable terms used as if they were proof."

Part 4 Q2